NaturaMed

Product Requirements Document

Version 1.2 | March 2026 | V1 — Web App

"Because there is no disease in this world that God hasn't made a cure for."

1. Problem Statement

Modern healthcare has conditioned people to reach for pharmaceutical solutions at the first sign of discomfort. This has accelerated the erosion of centuries of accumulated knowledge about medicinal plants, natural remedies, and root-cause approaches to everyday ailments. The result: a generation that knows how to manage symptoms chemically but has lost the ability to address health holistically.

Three compounding problems drive this:

- Knowledge fragmentation — Traditional remedy knowledge exists scattered across books, oral traditions, and unreliable websites with no unified, trustworthy digital home.
- Symptom-only thinking — People search for 'headache remedy' without ever asking why they have a headache. The digital health space reinforces this pattern.
- Pill-first default — Pharmaceutical options are always one click away. Natural alternatives require research effort most people don't have time for.

Vision	*Bring ancestral healing knowledge into the digital age — making it searchable, trustworthy, and cause-aware. Not to replace medicine, but to restore a layer of knowledge that was lost.*

2. Target Users

Primary audience for V1 (personal + close circle):

User Type	Description
The Wellness-Curious	People exploring natural health alternatives, not yet fully committed. Frustrated with side effects and looking for options.
The Natural Lifestyle Adherent	Already committed to organic, plant-based living. Wants a reliable digital reference for remedies they already trust.
The Skeptical Researcher	Wants to understand the 'why' behind symptoms before reaching for any solution, natural or pharmaceutical.
The Knowledge Keeper	Wants to preserve and reference traditional family or cultural remedy knowledge in a modern format.

Out of scope for V1:

- Medical professionals or practitioners
- Users managing serious, chronic, or acute conditions requiring clinical care
- Children or elderly users with complex medication interactions

3. Design Direction

3.1 Color Theme

The app uses a green and white color palette throughout. Green signals nature, healing, and trust. White keeps the UI clean and readable. No dark backgrounds, no clinical sterility.

Element	Color
Primary brand color	Forest green (#2D6A4F)
Backgrounds	White (#FFFFFF)
Accent / highlights	Light green (#D8F3DC)
Text	Near-black (#1B1B1B)
Caution badges	Warm amber — to stand out from green palette

3.2 Homepage Quote

The homepage displays the following quote, visible to every user on entry:

> *“Because there is no disease in this world that God hasn’t made a cure for.”*

Attribution note: The quote is sourced from Islamic hadith tradition. It is displayed with attribution, not anonymously, to respect its origin and add credibility.

4. Content Categories

19 top-level categories covering the full scope of natural wellness. Categories are data-driven — they can be added, renamed, or restructured without engineering changes. Children is confirmed as a V2 addition.

#	Category	Scope / Examples
1	**Beauty**	Purely cosmetic — acne, skincare, dryness, lip balm, hair care
2	**Anti-Aging**	Herbs, foods, and practices for longevity and skin aging
3	**Brain Health**	Cognitive function, focus, memory — lion's mane, ginkgo, adaptogens
4	**Reproductive Health**	Male & female — libido, erectile dysfunction, fertility
5	**Sleep**	Herbal teas, natural sleep aids, routines — chamomile, magnesium, coconut water
6	**Oral Health**	Natural toothpaste, bad breath, oil pulling, miswak stick
7	**Parasite Cleanse**	Herbs and protocols for natural parasite removal
8	**Vitamins**	How to obtain vitamins naturally through food and herbs
9	**Allergies**	Remedies to calm allergic reactions and their symptoms
10	**Mental Wellness**	Stress, anxiety, mood, relaxation herbs — ashwagandha, lavender, passionflower
11	**Home Cleaning**	Natural DIY cleaning recipes and household supplies
12	**Digestion & Gut Health**	Stomach ache, diarrhea, gas, bloating / Subcategory: gut health (probiotics, microbiome foods)
13	**Pain & Inflammation**	Systemic joint pain, arthritis, muscle soreness / Subcategory: Burns
14	**Head**	Headache, migraine only — strictly head-specific conditions
15	**Throat**	Sore throat, cough, congestion, mucus clearance
16	**Skin & Wounds**	Rashes, eczema, psoriasis, wounds, skin infections
17	**Eyes**	Eye strain, irritation, infection, dryness
18	**Ears**	Earache, ear infection, tinnitus remedies
19	**Fever & Immune**	Cold, flu, fever, common illness, immune support

V2 Addition	*Children — general health tips for babies and young kids. Deferred due to sensitivity around dosing and contraindications. Will require strongest disclaimer language of any category.*

5. Navigation & UX Structure

The app has multiple entry points to accommodate different user intents. The primary flow is category-first, with parallel shortcuts via search, the symptom engine, and the conversational entry prompt.

5.1 Primary Navigation Flow

Level	Content
Home	Conversational entry prompt (every session), search bar, 19 category tiles, Herb of the Day, Health Tip of the Day, homepage quote
Category Page	Condition/symptom tiles within that category (e.g. Head → Headache, Migraine)
Condition Page	Likely causes (selectable), remedy cards for that condition
Remedy Detail	Full ingredients, preparation steps, timeline, contraindications, source, disclaimer
Herb Detail	Description, medicinal properties, usage methods, precautions, sources. Deep Dive section (V2).

5.2 Parallel Entry Points

- Conversational entry prompt — AI-powered front door, routes user based on their described need (fires every session)
- Global search bar — fuzzy condition or herb search from any screen
- Symptom Engine — direct symptom-to-remedy shortcut
- Herb Library — A–Z browsable herb index
- Browse by Category — 19-category tile grid on home
- Preparation Methods — standalone reference section

6. Core Use Cases

UC-01 — Search by Condition

User searches for a common condition (e.g. ‘headache’, ‘inflammation’, ‘insomnia’). The app returns a structured results page with natural remedy cards. Each card includes: remedy name, key ingredients, preparation method, and caution notes.

UC-02 — Explore Likely Causes

Before or alongside remedy results, the app surfaces common root causes for the searched condition. For example, a headache search might show: dehydration, tension/posture, eye strain, poor sleep. The user can select a cause to filter or refine remedy recommendations.

Key Insight	*This cause-layer is what separates NaturaMed from a digital recipe book. It nudges users toward addressing the problem, not just the symptom.*

UC-03 — View Remedy Detail

User taps into a specific remedy to see: full ingredient list with quantities, step-by-step preparation, expected relief timeline, contraindications and caution flags (pregnancy, medications, allergies), and source/provenance note.

UC-04 — AI Holistic Healer Fallback

When a condition is not yet in the curated database, the app queries the AI agent in real time. The agent is not a generic LLM — it is prompted and tuned to behave as a holistic healer: reasoning about root causes, considering the whole person, and connecting cause to remedy in the spirit of the app’s vision. The response is displayed with a clear label: ‘AI-generated — not yet in curated database.’

UC-05 — Browse by Category

Users navigate via category tiles (e.g. Head, Throat, Skin, Sleep, Digestion, Immunity). Each category shows a list of common conditions and symptoms. Selecting one leads to the condition page with causes and remedies. This is the primary discovery path for users without a specific search term.

UC-06 — Herb Library (A–Z)

Users browse or search a library of common medicinal herbs and plants. Each entry includes: name, short description, medicinal properties, how to use it, precautions, and sources. Browsable alphabetically or by property.

UC-07 — Symptom Engine

User inputs one or more symptoms directly (e.g. ‘fatigue’ + ‘headache’). The system returns relevant remedies and herbs known to address those symptoms — bypassing the category → condition navigation flow. This is a faster path for users who know their symptoms but not their condition label. Not a diagnostic tool — no condition inference language.

UC-08 — Preparation Methods Reference

A standalone reference section explaining general preparation methods for herbal remedies: teas, infusions, tinctures, cold-infused oils, ointments, poultices, and more. Each method has: a description, step-by-step preparation guide, and typical use cases. Not condition-specific — a knowledge resource.

UC-09 — Herb of the Day

The homepage surfaces a featured herb each day with its name, a key property, and a link to the full herb detail page. Provides a passive discovery mechanic and a reason to return to the app daily.

UC-10 — Conversational Entry Prompt

Every time a user opens the app, a prompt appears asking what they are looking for today. The user types freely — e.g. ‘I’ve been feeling anxious and can’t sleep’ — and the AI intelligently routes them to relevant categories, conditions, herbs, or remedies. This is the conversational front door to the entire app, powered by the holistic healer agent. It replaces the cold category-grid experience with a warm, guided entry.

UC-11 — Health Tip of the Day

The homepage displays a daily general wellness suggestion. Not time-of-day specific — could be a food, a habit, an herb, a practice, or a piece of traditional wisdom. Rotates daily. Broader in scope than Herb of the Day — it covers any wellness domain. Curated content in V1, with AI-generation as a V2 option.

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7. Functional Requirements

7.1 Search & Discovery

- Full-text condition search with fuzzy matching (e.g. ‘headche’ finds ‘headache’)
- Search suggestions / autocomplete as user types
- Results ranked by DB first, AI fallback clearly labeled second
- Empty state handled gracefully with AI fallback — no dead ends

7.2 Condition & Cause Layer

- Each condition record includes 3–6 common causes
- Causes are selectable to filter remedy results
- Causes displayed before remedy list to encourage root-cause thinking

7.3 Remedy Cards

- Each remedy card shows: name, primary ingredient(s), prep time, and one-line description
- Tappable to expand full detail view
- Caution badges visible on card level (e.g. ‘Not during pregnancy’)

7.4 Remedy Detail View

- Full ingredient list with measurements
- Step-by-step preparation instructions
- Contraindications section (mandatory, even if empty)
- Source/provenance note (e.g. ‘Traditional Ayurvedic practice’, ‘European herbal tradition’)
- Sources / references list for the remedy
- Disclaimer footer on every remedy: remedies are not clinically tested and do not replace medical advice

7.5 AI Holistic Healer Agent

- Triggered automatically when condition not found in DB
- System prompt tuned to holistic healer persona — not a generic LLM response
- Agent reasons about root causes and whole-person context, consistent with the app’s vision
- Response always includes caution section and disclaimer
- AI results are never silently mixed with DB results — source is always labeled

7.6 Herb Library

- A–Z browsable index of medicinal herbs and plants
- Each entry: name, description, medicinal properties, usage methods, precautions, sources
- Searchable by name or property
- herb_of_day flag on schema to support daily rotation

7.7 Symptom Engine

- User can input one or more symptoms simultaneously
- Many-to-many mapping: symptoms → remedies/herbs
- Returns ranked remedy/herb cards relevant to the symptom combination
- No diagnosis language — framed as ‘commonly associated remedies’
- No dead ends — falls back to AI agent if no DB match found

7.8 Preparation Methods

- Standalone reference section, not tied to a specific condition or remedy
- Covers: tea, infusion, tincture, cold-infused oil, ointment, poultice, steam, compress
- Each method: description, step-by-step guide, typical use cases
- Linked contextually from remedy detail views where relevant

7.9 Herb of the Day

- Displayed on homepage — rotates daily
- Shows herb name, one key property, and a teaser
- Links to full herb detail page
- Driven by herb_of_day flag in DB or a simple date-based rotation

7.10 Conversational Entry Prompt

- Appears every time a user opens the app — not a one-time onboarding flow
- Free-text input: user describes what they’re looking for in natural language
- AI holistic healer agent interprets the input and routes to relevant categories, conditions, herbs, or remedies
- Dismissible — users who know where they’re going can skip it
- Response displayed as smart suggestions, not a chat thread

7.11 Health Tip of the Day

- Displayed on homepage, rotates daily
- Covers any wellness domain — food, habit, herb, practice, traditional wisdom
- Broader scope than Herb of the Day — the two widgets complement each other
- Curated content in V1, stored in a daily_tips table
- AI-generation of tips is a V2 option

7.12 Fun Facts

- Short, engaging facts about herbs, plants, or natural remedies
- Displayed contextually on herb/remedy pages or as a homepage widget
- Stored as a fun_fact field on herb records

7.11 Global Disclaimer

- Prominent disclaimer displayed on the homepage and as a one-time acknowledgment on first visit
- Footer disclaimer on every remedy and herb detail page
- Language: ‘This app is not a substitute for professional medical advice, diagnosis, or treatment. Always consult a qualified healthcare provider.’

7.12 Sources & References

- Every remedy and herb entry includes a sources[] field
- Sources displayed at the bottom of detail pages
- A dedicated Sources page lists the reference works, traditions, and databases used to build the curated content

7.13 Content Management

- Admin interface (simple, internal) for adding/editing conditions, causes, remedies, and herbs
- DB schema supports gradual migration from AI-generated to curated content
- Content versioning — track when records were added or updated

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8. Non-Functional Requirements

Requirement	Target
Performance	Page load under 2 seconds on mobile (LTE). Search results under 1 second for DB hits.
Responsiveness	Fully functional on mobile browsers (375px+) and desktop. No native app required in V1.
Availability	99% uptime acceptable for V1 (personal use). Vercel/hosting handles this automatically.
AI Latency	AI fallback responses under 5 seconds. Show a loading state — never blank.
Accessibility	WCAG AA compliance target. Good contrast, readable font sizes, keyboard navigable.
Safety	Global disclaimer on homepage. Disclaimer footer on every remedy and herb page. Caution flags surfaced prominently — not buried in detail.
Scalability	Architecture supports moving from personal use to public-facing without a rewrite.

9. Out of Scope — V1

- User accounts, profiles, or personalization
- Community features (remedy submissions, ‘tried it’ signals)
- Push notifications or reminders
- Native iOS / Android apps
- Drug interaction checker or clinical validation layer
- Monetization, ads, or premium tiers
- Offline mode
- Multi-language support
- Deep Dive extended content on herb/remedy pages
- Symptom engine diagnostic inference (condition suggestion from symptom clusters)
- Natural house cleaning recipes category

V2 Candidates	*Community features, user personalization, Deep Dive content, natural cleaning category, native app, symptom-to-condition inference. Architecture will not block these — they are deferred, not abandoned.*

10. Tech Stack Recommendations

These are recommendations, not a menu. Each call is based on your constraints: solo builder, web-first, AI-integrated, needs to scale if needed.

Layer	Recommendation	
Layer	**Recommendation**	**Rationale**
Frontend	Next.js (React)	Best-in-class for responsive web apps. SSR gives fast initial loads critical for mobile. Huge ecosystem. Deploys trivially to Vercel.
Styling	Tailwind CSS	Fast to build with, easy to keep consistent. Perfect for a solo builder. Avoids CSS sprawl.
Backend / API	Next.js API Routes	No separate backend needed in V1. API routes handle search, AI calls, and DB queries. One repo, one deploy.
Database	PostgreSQL (via Supabase)	Supabase gives you Postgres + a simple admin UI + auth ready when you need it. Free tier is generous.
AI Integration	Anthropic Claude API	Best instruction-following for structured health content. Haiku model for cost efficiency on fallback calls. Prompt tuned to holistic healer persona.
Hosting	Vercel	Zero-config deploys from Git. Free tier handles personal use. Scales automatically.
Search	Postgres full-text search (V1)	Built into Supabase. Migrate to Algolia or Typesense if DB grows beyond ~500 records.

Cross-Platform Notes

- Next.js renders server-side by default — mobile users get fast first paint without a heavy JS bundle
- Tailwind's responsive utilities (sm:, md:, lg:) make mobile-first layout straightforward
- No React Native needed — a well-built responsive web app is indistinguishable from a native app for content browsing
- If native app becomes a requirement later, the Next.js API layer becomes the backend for a React Native frontend with minimal rework

11. Content Architecture — DB Schema

Designed to support both curated and AI-generated content from day one:

conditions { id, name, slug, category, summary, causes[] }

remedies { id, condition_id, name, ingredients[], steps[], cautions[], source, sources[], is_curated, created_at }

causes { id, condition_id, label, description }

herbs { id, name, slug, description, medicinal_properties[], usage_methods[], precautions[], sources[], fun_fact, herb_of_day, created_at }

symptoms { id, label, description }

symptom_remedies { symptom_id, remedy_id } — many-to-many

symptom_herbs { symptom_id, herb_id } — many-to-many

preparation_methods { id, name, description, steps[], use_cases[] }

daily_tips { id, content, category, date_shown, created_at }

The is_curated flag is the key field — it determines whether the remedy came from research or was AI-generated. This drives UI labeling and content graduation from AI fallback to curated DB entry.

12. Suggested Build Phases

Phase	Scope
Phase 1 — Foundation	Next.js project setup, Supabase DB, basic search UI, remedy detail view. Manually seed 10–15 conditions to validate the content model.
Phase 2 — AI Holistic Agent	Integrate Claude API. Build holistic healer system prompt. Handle fallback gracefully in UI. Add disclaimer and caution logic.
Phase 3 — Cause Layer	Add causes to conditions. Build cause-filter UI on search results. This is the feature that makes the app meaningfully different.
Phase 4 — Herb Library & Prep Methods	Build herb library with A–Z browsing. Add preparation methods reference section. Seed 30–40 herbs.
Phase 5 — Engagement Features	Herb of the Day, Health Tip of the Day, fun facts, conversational entry prompt, homepage quote, global disclaimer acknowledgment flow.
Phase 6 — Symptom Engine	Build symptom-to-remedy mapping. Multi-symptom input UI. Many-to-many DB relations.
Phase 7 — Polish & Content	Mobile responsiveness audit, empty/loading states, admin content tool, expand DB to 40–50 conditions.
Phase 8 — V2 Planning	Evaluate community features, user accounts, native app, Deep Dive content, and cleaning category based on real usage.